

Zero Beat



Kingsport Amateur Radio Club August 2026 Edition

President Notes

We had a Fantastic Club Picnic this year!!! With 26 folks showing up, lots of Great Food, a World Renowned Chef and a tremendous amount of discussion between members, how could this picnic not qualify for "One Of The Best"?

Although supper was at 1800, folks showed up at 1630 and did not leave until 2030. I believe one factor that was a plus is the fact that we met at Netherland Inn and the Picnic area was smaller. We met new folks, friends we had not seen in a while and it was easy to share stories as we switched tables in a closer space. Everyone brought food, too, and we lacked for nothing.

To all of you that brought food, drinks and helped organize and clean up, A Big Thank You goes out to you!!!

Ron Burns, NR3E, was our World Famous Chef with assistance from Matt Babler, KQ4CCP. Thank you so much, for the good food and all of the work!!!

A highlight of the evening was the awarding of SOTA GOAT to Matt Babler!!! What an Amazing Achievement!!! Congratulations Matt!!!

Some news on the repeater: Due the the repairs on the repeater taking longer than expected we are soliciting assistance from outside of our club.

Don't Forget to join your friends for lunch at noon at John B's Family Kitchen 2608 N John B Dennis HWY this Wednesday July 19th. SEE YOU THERE!!!

Larry Dale KD4FTN

President

Club News

The KARC foxhunt will take place on August 15th. It begins at 3 p.m. And check-ins starting at 2:45 p.m. On the 146.970 repeater. Participants can start from any location in the area, keeping in mind that the foxes will be hidden within the city limits, so having a map on your phone is advisable. All fox frequencies are listed on the [W4TRC.org website](https://w4trc.org). If you are interested in joining the first trip, please contact Josh Carmack or Justin Compton to arrange a ride. Their phone numbers and email addresses are also available on the website.

HHART & KARC meets at Randall's every 3rd Wednesday of the month from 10:00 AM- 12:00 PM.

We need Net Control volunteers for our Sunday Evening 2 Meter Net! No monthly commitment – just sign up for the weeks you want. We're looking for both a primary and backup Net Control operator each week.

Not sure what a net is? It's a scheduled on-air gathering where licensed hams check in, share information, and stay connected with the local community. Whether you're newly licensed or a seasoned operator, it's one of the best ways to stay active in the hobby – and running Net Control is a great way to give back!

Sign-up, schedule & net script: <https://w4trc.org/nets>
Questions: netcontrol@w4trc.org

Amateur Radio News

Club Update Reminder In an effort to maintain updated ARRL Affiliated Club records, we are urging radio clubs to complete the required annual Affiliated Club review now. [Continue Reading](#)

New ARRL Maine Section Manager Cory Golob, KU1U, of Sabattus, Maine, has been appointed as the ARRL Maine Section Manager as of August 3, 2026. [Continue Reading](#)

Order Your ARRL America250 Worked All States Award Certificate.If you've already confirmed contacts with all 50 states, you can now order your commemorative award certificate. [Continue Reading](#)

FCC Cites GMRS Licensee for Illegal Linked Repeater Network.The FCC Enforcement Bureau has issued a Notice of Violation to Gary M. Beckstedt, Sr., of Newnan, Georgia, for operating a network of nearly two dozen linked General Mobile Radio Service (GMRS) repeaters in violation of FCC rules for the service. [Continue Reading](#)

Amateur Radio Supports Wisconsin Tornado Recovery. On July 27, July 30, and August 1, 2026, members of the Green Bay Mike and Key Club, who are also members of the Brown-Kewaunee County Amateur Radio Emergency Service® (ARES®), deployed to Winnebago County, Wisconsin, following a tornado that struck on July 27. [Continue Reading](#)

ARRL 2025 Annual Report Now Available.ARRL The National Association for Amateur Radio® has published its 2025 Annual Report. [Continue Reading](#)

Colombian Emergency Network Activated Following Earthquake.Radio amateurs asked to keep frequencies clear following earthquake in Colombia. [Continue Reading](#)

10-Year-Old Receives Ham License and More.A brand-new young ham in Arizona got more than he was expecting after passing his amateur radio Technician class license exam earlier this month. [Continue Reading](#)

ARISS Receives Challenger-7 Recognition.ARISS, Amateur Radio on the International Space Station, has been honored with the prestigious Challenger-7 Recognition, a national honor celebrating organizations whose work reflects the spirit, vision, and values of the seven crew members of the Space Shuttle. [Continue Reading](#)

ARRL Year of the Club Contests Celebrate Outstanding Club Websites and Newsletters.As part of ARRL's 2026 Year of the Club spotlight, Affiliated Clubs were invited to show how they use two important communications tools – their websites and newsletters – to engage members, strengthen their organizations, and promote amateur radio. [Continue Reading](#)

Colombian Amateurs Help in Earthquake Response; Clear Frequencies Requested.Amateur radio operators in Colombia are providing significant communications support following the major earthquake and aftershocks that struck the country on August 10, 2026. [Continue Reading](#)

IP400 Project Enters Third Phase.New hardware and data mode brings high data rates to nearly any FM radio. [Continue Reading](#)

HAARP to Conduct Research Campaign Supporting PARS Summer School.21 experiments related to ionospheric research will take place. [Continue Reading](#)

15th Annual NJQRP Skeeter Hunt to Take Place This Weekend.Event promotes QRP operators in the field. [Continue Reading](#)

Ham Fair 2026 Updates: Kenwood and Uniden to Showcase New Radios.Kenwood to celebrate its 80th anniversary. [Continue Reading](#)

CHOTA 2026: Churches and Chapels on the Air.Look for activity on 20 meters 10 AM to 4 PM. [Continue Reading](#)

AMSAT Canada Begins Offering Membership Options.AMSAT-CA supports amateur radio in space. [Continue Reading](#)

FCC Ham "Call Book" in PDF and CSV formats.The call book supports Ham Radio enthusiasts who suffer little-to-no internet bandwidth while chasing QSOs – or when your favorite search site goes down for (un)scheduled maintenance. [Continue Reading](#)

Hamfests/Conventions – Let's Go !

08/29/2026 – Northeast Tennessee Radio Community Hamfest,
Location: Erwin, TN. Website: <http://www.netrc423.org>

09/12/2026 – East Tennessee Hamfest, Location: Dandridge, TN.
Website: <https://lakewayarc.org/hamfest/>

09/19/2026 – W4DXCC by SEDCO, Location: Pigeon Forge, Sponsor:
SEDCO Website: <http://www.w4dxcc.org>

SKYWARN

If you are interested in being a SKYWARN Storm Spotter, please visit <https://www.weather.gov/mrx/skywarn>

To join our area SKYWARN organization, which is the Northeast Tennessee District 7 SKYWARN, please visit their website <https://www.skywarn7.org/>

The Importance of NOAA Weather Radios and Why You Should Own One. [Continue Reading](#)

Important Information

President: Larry Dale (KD4FTN)

Vice President: Justin Compton (K04DCD)

Treasurer: Rick Curtis (W4BXL)

Secretary: Christina Compton (KQ4CDM)

Repeater Trustee: Joshua Carmack (N4JHC)

The club meetings will be held on the second Thursday of each month at Eastman's Toy F. Reid Employee Center; Room 219; 400 S. Wilcox Dr; Kingsport, TN 37660 at 7:00 PM. Everyone is welcome to attend.

Club Repeaters, located on Bays Mountain 2 Meter: 146.970 MHz (-) PL Tone 123.0 Hz (Analog or Yaesu System Fusion C4FM Input / Analog Only Output) Echolink: W4TRC-R

70 Centimeters: 443.325 MHz (+) PL Tone 123.0 Hz (Automatic Mode Select (AMS) for Yaesu System Fusion C4FM and Analog FM)

70 Centimeters: 443.175 (+) (Yaesu System Fusion C4FM Only)

Sunday Night Informational Net on 146.970 MHz at 8:30 PM Eastern Time.

For more information about the KARC and amateur radio, please visit our website at www.w4trc.org or email us at contact@w4trc.org

Erik McCord, WX4ET, is the editor of Zero Beat, a monthly newsletter.